Missed calls by trade (UK)

Missed calls by trade (UK) is an open CC BY 4.0 dataset from Ringzel of 10 verified, source-linked statistics on how often UK small businesses miss phone calls and what it costs them.

This folder holds the master copy: missed-calls-by-trade-uk.csv, DATA-DICTIONARY.md and a 2-page report.pdf.

Keywords: missed calls, missed calls UK, small business, SME, tradespeople, customer calls, call handling, lost revenue, AI receptionist, United Kingdom, open data

Headline findings

- UK small businesses lose an estimated **£3.67bn a year (indicative)** to missed calls. BT calls the figure indicative because it is modelled from owners' own estimates. BT
- **67%** of UK SMEs miss at least one call a day that they believe loses them business. BT
- Average yearly loss to missed calls: **£1,597** for firms with 1–9 staff and **£3,753** for firms with 10–49 staff (self-reported). BT
- **58%** of SMEs spend between 30 minutes and 2 hours a day answering customer calls, and **85%** say this interrupts other work. BT
- **75%** of UK consumers give a business three call attempts before giving up; **58%** would tell friends and family to avoid a business that didn't pick up. BT
- **34%** of tradespeople believe they've lost work by not answering the phone, and **60%** struggle to answer while working. Fix Radio

Questions and answers

How much do missed calls cost UK small businesses?

About £3.67bn a year, an indicative figure modelled by BT Business/Censuswide (September 2026) from 1,500 SMEs' own estimates. That works out at £1,597 a year for firms with 1–9 staff and £3,753 for firms with 10–49 staff. Source: https://newsroom.bt.com/ai-from-bt-launched-to-help-uk-firms-adopt-ai-with-confidence-targeting-37-billion-lost-through-missed-calls/

How many UK small businesses miss calls?

67% say they miss at least one call a day that they believe loses them business (BT/Censuswide, 2026). Source: https://newsroom.bt.com/ai-from-bt-launched-to-help-uk-firms-adopt-ai-with-confidence-targeting-37-billion-lost-through-missed-calls/

How many times will a customer try calling before giving up?

75% of UK consumers give a business three attempts, and 58% would tell friends and family to avoid one that didn't pick up (BT/Censuswide, 2,000 adults, 2026). Source: https://newsroom.bt.com/ai-from-bt-launched-to-help-uk-firms-adopt-ai-with-confidence-targeting-37-billion-lost-through-missed-calls/

Do tradespeople lose work from missed calls?

34% of tradespeople surveyed believe they have, and 60% struggle to answer the phone while working (Fix Radio, October 2022, 220+ tradespeople). Source: https://www.fixradio.co.uk/fix-feed/construction-news/post/34-of-tradespeople-lose-work-by-not-answering-phone/

What are missed-call rates for plumbers, salons, clinics or estate agents?

This dataset doesn't include them. We found no independent, verifiable source for per-trade missed-call rates in the UK.

Gaps: no per-trade missed-call rates

We couldn't find any independent, verifiable source for missed-call rates or losses by individual trade (e.g. plumbers, salons, clinics, estate agents, garages, law firms, accountants or vets). Ofcom, ONS and the FSB don't publish them. This dataset therefore makes no claims about specific trades beyond the Fix Radio survey of tradespeople. Contributions of public, citable per-trade figures are welcome.

Methodology

We searched for public UK missed-call statistics from regulators, government, trade bodies and surveys. Every figure was re-checked on its live source page on 24 October 2026 and copied as published. We dropped any number we couldn't find on a live page, any US data, and statistics from companies that compete with Ringzel, with one exception. BT is included because it is the largest UK business telecoms provider, but its research was commissioned by BT Business, which sells its own AI receptionist. The dataset contains no Ringzel customer or demo-call data.

Limitations

- BT figures: commissioned by BT Business (seller of its own AI receptionist) and run by Censuswide; the £3.67bn is indicative.
- Fix Radio: a media poll that doesn't publish its method in detail.
- The two sources use different samples and years, so don't compare their rows directly.
- Ringzel, which publishes this dataset, works in the call-answering market.

Licence

CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). Credit: "Ringzel (RINGZEL LTD, company no. 17507564), Missed calls by trade (UK), 2026". The underlying statistics belong to the sources cited; please cite them too.

About Ringzel

Ringzel (https://ringzel.com) is an AI receptionist for businesses of any type. You keep your own number and divert calls to Ringzel when you can't answer, and it's set up in under 5 minutes. RINGZEL LTD, company no. 17507564, 71-75 Shelton Street, Covent Garden, London WC2H 9JQ. Tel +44 7457 410396.

Related guides:

- AI receptionist cost guide (UK): https://ringzel.com/en-gb/blog/ai-receptionist-cost-uk/
- What a missed call costs a UK trade: https://ringzel.com/en-gb/blog/missed-call-cost-uk-trade/
- Industry pages: https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/ (plumbers https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/plumbers/, electricians https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/electricians/, salons https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/salons/, clinics https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/clinics/, dentists https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/dentists/, estate agents https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/estate-agents/, law firms https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/law-firms/, garages https://ringzel.com/en-gb/industries/garages/)

Where to find this dataset

- GitHub (canonical): https://github.com/ringzel/uk-missed-calls-dataset
- Hugging Face: https://huggingface.co/datasets/ringzel/missed-calls-by-trade-uk
- Zenodo (DOI): https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23605717